Summary

Job Title: Python Code Quality Annotator — Academic Research Study (PhD Thesis)

Overview

I am a PhD researcher conducting a study on automated software quality assessment in Python codebases. I need two independent software engineering practitioners to review a set of 384 Python functions and judge whether each function exhibits a specific code quality issue.

This is a paid annotation task for academic research. Your judgements will form part of the ground truth evaluation dataset for a published study.

What You Will Do

You will receive an Excel spreadsheet containing 384 Python functions. For each function, you will:

1. Read the function body (actual Python code, 5–50 lines on average)
2. Review the provided metrics (lines of code, complexity score, parameter count)
3. Answer one question: does this function exhibit the described code quality issue?
4. Enter 1 (yes) or 0 (no) in the provided column
5. Add a short note for any borderline cases

A clear annotation guide with criteria and examples is included in the spreadsheet. You do not need to know academic terminology — the guide explains everything in plain language.

The Four Code Quality Issues You Will Evaluate

Each function is evaluated for one of these four issues:

- Code Smell — Is this function too long, too complex, or does it take too many parameters to be easily understood?
- Anti-Pattern — Does this function have too many branches, call too many other functions, or belong to an oversized class?
- Poor Naming — Is the function name unclear, too short, or does it fail to communicate what the function does?
- Poor Documentation — Does this function lack a meaningful docstring explaining its purpose?

Requirements

- At least 3 years of professional Python development experience
- Familiarity with code quality and software maintenance in real-world projects
- Ability to work independently without discussing with other annotators

- Reliable communication and ability to return the completed spreadsheet within 7 days
- No prior knowledge of this specific research project

What Is NOT Required
- Academic background or knowledge of formal software engineering research
- Knowledge of specific tools like Pylint or SonarQube
- Experience with machine learning or data science

Deliverable
The completed Excel spreadsheet with your annotation column filled in (1 or 0 for each of the 384 rows) and notes for any cases you found unclear.

Time Commitment
Estimated 2–3 hours total. Most functions take 15–30 seconds to evaluate once you are familiar with the criteria.

Important Notes
- This task requires independent work. You must not discuss your annotations with anyone else until after you have submitted.
- Your participation will be acknowledged in the published research paper.
- Compensation is provided for your time regardless of how your annotations align with the model's predictions; there are no right or wrong answers, only your professional judgement.
- This study has been conducted under academic research guidelines. Your data will be used solely for the purposes of this research.